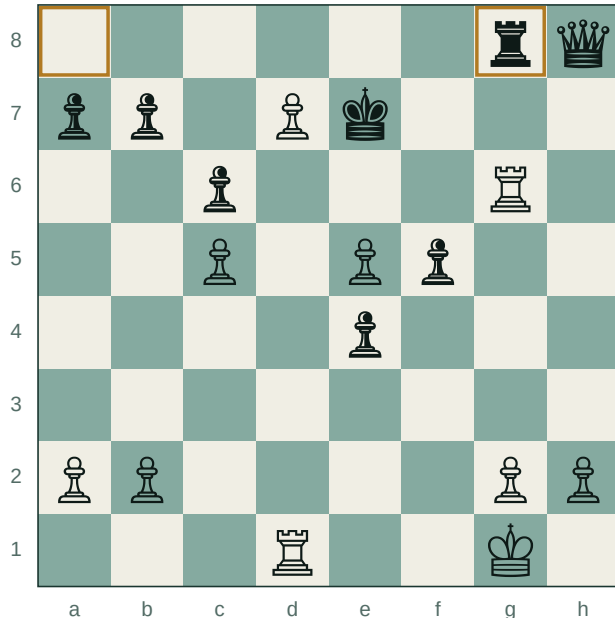


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 35

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 34...Rg8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Rxcg8 Qxcg8 36. d8=Q+ Qxd8 37. Rxd8

35.Rxcg8 The rook captures the rook on g8. Recorded reply: **35...Qxcg8**.

36.d8=Q+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen. From d8 it attacks king on e7 and queen on g8. Recorded reply: **36...Qxd8**.

37.Rxd8 The rook captures the queen on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -2 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e7. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.